

Word family: ****insist / insists / insisted / insisting / insistence / insistent / insistently****

****Base word:**** insist

****Third-person singular:**** insists

****Past tense:**** insisted

****Past participle:**** insisted

**** -ing form:**** insisting

****Related forms:**** insistence, insistent, insistently

****Useful constructions/extensions:**** insist on + noun/-ing, insist that + clause, insist on doing, insist on something, insist that someone do something, insist upon, at someone's insistence, insistent demand, insistent voice

****Part of speech:**** verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your passage contains:

> "Whenever I visit, she ****insists on making tea and cutting fruit for everyone****, even when we tell her to rest."

Here, ****insist**** means:

****to firmly continue wanting to do something and not easily accept another person's suggestion to stop or do otherwise.****

Meaning in this passage

In:

> ****she insists on making tea and cutting fruit****

your grandmother repeatedly wants to do these things herself even when other people tell her:

> "You should rest."

She does not merely ****offer****.

She strongly maintains:

> "No, I'll do it."

So ****insist**** expresses:

* firmness;

* persistence;

* unwillingness to give up the action;

* strong personal determination.

****Meaning:**** To firmly maintain that you will do something, despite another person suggesting otherwise.

****繁體中文： ** **堅持要做某事；即使別人勸阻或提出不同做法，仍然不改變自己的決定****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “She insists on making tea and cutting fruit for everyone.”

「她總是****堅持要****為大家泡茶、切水果。」

So:

****insist on doing something = 堅持要做某事****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****insist on + -ing (堅持要做某事) — 堅持做；堅持要****

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To firmly continue wanting to perform an action, even when others may disagree or suggest otherwise.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She ****insists on making tea and cutting fruit for everyone****.”

「她總是****堅持要****為大家泡茶、切水果******。」

Practice 2

> “He ****insisted on paying**** for dinner.”

「他****堅持要付晚餐的錢****。」

Practice 3

> “She ****insisted on carrying**** the bags herself.”

「她****堅持要自己拿那些袋****。」

****insist on doing** = 即使別人有其他建議，仍堅定地要求 / 決定自己要做某事******

2. ****insist on + noun** (堅持要求某事) — 堅持要；堅持要求******

A major grammatical pattern.

Practice 4

> “She ****insisted on an apology****.”

「她****堅持要求道歉****。」

Practice 5

> “The customer ****insisted on a refund****.”

「顧客****堅持要求退款****。」

****insist on + noun** = 強烈而堅定地要求某件事必須發生 / 提供******

3. ****insist that + clause** (堅稱某事是真的) — 堅稱；堅持說******

A major separate meaning.

****Meaning:**** To say very firmly that something is true, especially when others doubt or disagree.

Practice 6

> “She ****insisted that she was fine****.”

「她****堅稱自己沒事****。」

Practice 7

> “He ****insisted that the report was accurate****.”

「他****堅稱這份報告是準確的****。」

****insist that + statement** = 即使別人懷疑 / 不同意，仍堅定地表示某件事是真實的******

This is different from:

> insist on doing

which concerns action.

4. **insist that something happened / is true (堅稱) — 堅持說；斷言**

Practice 8

> “She **insisted that she had locked the door**.”

「她**堅稱自己已經鎖了門**。」

Practice 9

> “He **insists that he never received the message**.”

「他**堅稱自己從未收到那則訊息**。」

insist = 對某個事實 / 說法保持非常堅定的立場

5. **insist that someone do something (堅持要求某人做) — 堅持要求**

Another major construction.

Practice 10

> “She **insisted that I sit down**.”

「她**堅持要我坐下**。」

Practice 11

> “The doctor **insisted that he rest**.”

「醫生**堅持要求他休息**。」

insist that someone do something = 強烈要求某人採取某項行動

This differs from:

> insist that something is true.

Same structure, different function.

6. **insist that + subjunctive/base verb (正式語法) — 堅持要求.....**

In formal English, especially American English, the verb after **insist that** may remain in the base form.

Practice 12

> “They **insisted that the meeting begin** on time.”

「他們**堅持要求會議準時開始**。」

Practice 13

> “She **insisted that he apologize**.”

「她**堅持要求他道歉**。」

insist that + base verb = 正式地表示某人強烈要求某行動發生

British English may also use:

> should + verb

for example:

> “She insisted that he should apologize.”

7. **insist on someone doing something (堅持要某人做) — 堅持要求某人做**

A common alternative construction.

Practice 14

> “She **insisted on me staying** for dinner.”

「她**堅持要我留下來吃晚飯**。」

Practice 15

> “They insisted on everyone wearing a badge.”

「他們**堅持要求每個人佩戴名牌**。」

****insist on + person + -ing = 堅持要求某人進行某項行動****

In more formal grammar, possessive forms may occur:

> insist on ****my**** staying

but ordinary speech often uses:

> insist on ****me**** staying.

8. ****insist upon (堅持要求) — insist on 的較正式形式****

A more formal variant.

Practice 16

> “The contract ****insists upon**** strict confidentiality.”

「合約****堅持要求 / 規定必須****嚴格保密。」

Practice 17

> “She ****insisted upon**** seeing the manager.”

「她****堅持要見經理****。」

****insist upon = insist on ; 較正式 / 較書面****

For most learners:

> ****insist on****

is the safest everyday form.

9. ****insist = refuse to change your position (堅持立場) — 堅持己見 ; 不讓步****

A broader underlying sense.

Practice 18

> “I suggested leaving early, but he ****insisted****.”

「我建議提早離開，但他仍然****堅持自己的決定****。」

Practice 19

> “She ****insisted****, despite everyone's objections.”

「儘管大家反對，她仍然****堅持己見****。」

****insist** = 即使受到反對，也不願改變自己的要求、決定或立場******

10. ****insist on doing it yourself** (堅持親自做) — 一定要自己做******

A very common interpersonal use and especially close to your passage.

Practice 20

> “My grandmother always ****insists on doing everything herself****.”

「我外婆總是****堅持所有事情都要自己做****。」

Practice 21

> “He insisted on fixing it himself.”

「他****堅持要自己修理****。」

****insist on doing it yourself** = 即使別人可以幫忙，也強烈希望親自完成******

This is almost exactly the social dynamic in your passage.

11. ****insist = press strongly for a preferred choice** (執意要求) — 執意；強烈要求******

Practice 22

> “He ****insisted on the larger room****.”

「他****執意要較大的房間****。」

Practice 23

> “She insisted on taking the earlier train.”

「她**執意要坐較早的火車**。」

insist = 對某個選擇有強烈要求，不願接受替代方案

12. **insistence (堅持；堅決要求) — 堅持；強烈要求**

A major related noun.

Practice 24

> “At her **insistence**, we stayed for dinner.”

「在她的**堅持要求下**，我們留下來吃晚飯。」

Practice 25

> “His **insistence on accuracy** slowed the process.”

「他對準確性的**堅持**令流程變慢。」

insistence = 堅持某項要求、立場、做法或標準的行為 / 態度

13. **at someone's insistence (在某人堅持要求下) — 應某人堅持要求**

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 26

> “At my grandmother's **insistence**, I took some fruit home.”

「在外婆的**堅持要求下**，我帶了一些水果回家。」

Practice 27

> “The meeting was postponed at the manager's insistence.”

「會議在經理**堅持要求下**延期。」

at someone's insistence = 因為某人強烈要求，所以某事最終發生

14. **insistence on + noun/-ing** (對.....的堅持) — 堅持某項原則 / 做法

Practice 28

> “Her **insistence on punctuality** is well known.”

「她對準時的**堅持**人盡皆知。」

Practice 29

> “His insistence on checking everything twice can be frustrating.”

「他**堅持**每件事檢查兩次，有時會令人很煩惱。」

insistence on X = 對某種做法、標準或要求一直不肯放鬆

15. **insistent** = demanding attention / persistent (持續而強烈的) — 堅持不懈的；強烈要求的

A major related adjective.

Practice 30

> “She was **insistent** that we stay for tea.”

「她很**堅持**要我們留下來喝茶。」

Practice 31

> “He became increasingly **insistent**.”

「他變得愈來愈**堅持 / 強硬**。」

insistent = 反覆而堅定地要求某事，不容易接受拒絕

16. **insistent voice/tone** (堅決而強烈的語氣) — 堅決的；不容拒絕的

Practice 32

> “There was an **insistent tone** in her voice.”

「她的聲音帶著一種**堅決、不容拒絕的語氣**。」

Practice 33

> “His voice became more insistent.”

「他的語氣變得更加**強硬而堅持**。」

insistent tone/voice = 語氣反覆 / 堅決地要求別人注意、同意或行動

17. **insistent** = persistent sound/signal (持續不斷的) — 持續而令人無法忽視的

A useful extension beyond people.

Practice 34

> “An **insistent knocking** came from the door.”

「門外傳來**持續而急促的敲門聲**。」

Practice 35

> “The phone made an **insistent ringing sound**.”

「電話發出**持續而催促的鈴聲**。」

insistent = 某種聲音 / 訊號持續出現、強烈到難以忽視

This is a genuine extension of the persistence idea.

18. **insistently** (堅持地 / 持續催促地) — 堅決地；一再地

The related adverb.

Practice 36

> “‘You must eat something,’ she said **insistently**.”

「『你一定要吃點東西。』她**堅持地**說。」

Practice 37

> “The child called **insistently** for his mother.”

「孩子**不停而急切地**叫媽媽。」

insistently = 以反覆、堅定、難以忽視的方式要求 / 呼喚

19. **insistent demand/request** (強烈要求) — 堅決要求；一再要求

Practice 38

> “They ignored his **insistent demands**.”

「他們無視他的**一再強烈要求**。」

Practice 39

> “She made an **insistent request** to speak to the manager.”

「她**堅決要求**與經理交談。」

insistent request/demand = 反覆而強烈、不輕易接受拒絕的要求

20. **insist** = emphasize correctness despite disagreement (堅持認為) — 堅持認為；不改口

Practice 40

> “He **insists** that his interpretation is correct.”

「他**堅持認為**自己的理解是正確的。」

Practice 41

> “She **insists** that nothing unusual happened.”

「她**堅稱**沒有發生任何異常事情。」

insist = 在有人懷疑 / 反對時仍堅定維持自己的說法

This is one of the biggest contrasts learners need to understand.

Important distinction: ****insist on doing vs insist that something is true****

This is the most important distinction.

****insist on doing something****

= 堅持要做某事

> “She insisted on making tea.”

****insist that something is true****

= 堅稱某件事是真的

> “She insisted that she was fine.”

These are not the same concept.

One concerns:

> ****action / demand****

The other concerns:

> ****truth / claim****

Important distinction: ****insist on + noun vs insist that + clause****

Noun:

> “She insisted on a refund.”

= 她堅持要求退款。

Clause:

> “She insisted that the product was faulty.”

= 她堅稱產品有問題。

The first is normally a ****demand****.

The second may simply be a **strong assertion**.

Important distinction: **insist vs **demand****

**insist**

= firmly maintain a request, choice, or claim.

**demand**

= require something very strongly and often more forcefully.

Compare:

> “She insisted on paying.”

= 她堅持要付錢。

> “She demanded payment.”

= 她強硬要求付款。

Demand generally sounds stronger and more confrontational.

Important distinction: **insist vs **ask****

**ask**

= request something.

**insist**

= continue to require it strongly, often despite resistance.

> “She asked me to stay.”

= 她請我留下。

> “She insisted that I stay.”

= 她堅持要我留下。

The second leaves much less room for refusal.

Important distinction: **insist vs request**

request

can be polite/formal and does not necessarily imply pressure.

insist

implies:

> the speaker is not willing to easily accept “no.”

So:

> insist

is stronger than:

> request.

Important distinction: **insist vs suggest**

Nearly opposite force levels.

suggest

= offer an idea for consideration.

insist

= maintain strongly that this should happen.

> “She suggested that I rest.”

= 她建議我休息。

> “She insisted that I rest.”

= 她堅持要求我休息。

Important distinction: **insist** vs **encourage**

encourage

= give support/confidence to help someone choose to act.

insist

= strongly require/maintain that the action happen.

Encouragement preserves more choice.

Important distinction: **insist** vs **persist**

These look similar but are not interchangeable.

insist

= strongly maintain a demand, claim, or decision.

persist

= continue doing something despite difficulty/opposition.

> “She insisted on paying.”

= 堅持要付錢。

> “She persisted in trying.”

= 她不斷繼續嘗試。

Persist emphasizes continuation; **insist** emphasizes firmness of demand/position.

Important distinction: **insist** vs **maintain**

In the “say something is true” meaning:

insist

often suggests:

- * disagreement;
- * doubt;
- * strong emphasis.

maintain

is more formal and means:

> continue to claim that something is true.

> "He maintains that he was not there."

more formal and less emotionally forceful.

Important distinction: **insist vs claim**

claim

= state something as true, often without proving it.

insist

= continue to assert it firmly, especially when challenged.

So:

> someone can make a claim once,

but:

> insist

suggests strong persistence.

Important distinction: **insist vs argue**

argue that

= give reasons for a position.

****insist that****

= firmly state/maintain the position.

You can insist without providing an argument.

Important distinction: ****insist vs refuse****

****insist****

= strongly maintain what you want to happen.

****refuse****

= strongly say no to something.

They may occur together:

> “She insisted on helping and refused to rest.”

= 她堅持幫忙，而且拒絕休息。

This fits your passage very naturally.

Important distinction: ****insist vs be determined****

****be determined to do****

= have strong personal intention.

****insist on doing****

often additionally involves:

> another person may object, suggest otherwise, or try to stop you.

So in your passage:

> grandmother is determined to make tea

but ****insists on making tea**** also highlights the family trying to persuade her to rest.

Important distinction: **insist that + indicative vs base verb**

The meaning depends on whether **that-clause** reports a claim or a demanded action.

Claim:

> “She insisted that she **was** fine.”

= 她堅稱自己沒事。

Demand:

> “She insisted that he **leave**.”

= 她堅持要求他離開。

The grammar itself helps reveal the meaning.

Important distinction: **insist on vs persist in**

insist on doing

= strongly maintain that the action should be done.

persist in doing

= continue doing it repeatedly despite difficulty/opposition.

Example:

> “He insisted on speaking first.”

= 他堅持要先說。

> “He persisted in interrupting.”

= 他一直不停打斷別人。

Important distinction: **insistence vs persistence**

****insistence****

= firmness in demanding/asserting.

****persistence****

= continued effort/action over time despite difficulty.

Your grandmother's behaviour is:

> ****insistence**** if she strongly says she will make tea.

It may also show:

> ****persistence**** if she keeps doing it repeatedly over time.

Different emphasis.

Important distinction: ****insistent vs persistent****

****insistent****

= demanding attention/compliance.

****persistent****

= continuing for a long time / refusing to stop.

An:

> insistent voice

sounds demanding.

A:

> persistent problem

keeps continuing.

Important distinction: ****at someone's insistence vs because someone asked****

because someone asked

= they requested it.

at someone's insistence

= their request was strong enough that the action happened because they would not easily accept another outcome.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **insist** family is not huge, but it has several important grammatical and semantic contrasts:

- * **insist on doing** = 堅持要做
- * **insist on + noun** = 堅持要求某物 / 某結果
- * **insist that + statement** = 堅稱某事為真
- * **insist that someone do** = 堅持要求某人做
- * **insist on someone doing** = 堅持要某人做
- * **insist upon** = 較正式的 insist on
- * **insist — maintain position** = 堅持己見 / 不讓步
- * **insist on doing it yourself** = 堅持親自做
- * **insistence** = 堅持 / 強烈要求
- * **at someone's insistence** = 在某人堅持要求下
- * **insistence on** = 對某標準 / 做法的堅持
- * **insistent** = 堅持要求的 / 持續催促的
- * **insistent voice/tone** = 堅決、不容拒絕的語氣
- * **insistent sound** = 持續而令人難以忽視的聲音
- * **insistently** = 堅決地 / 一再催促地

The main semantic branches are:

> **firmly demand that something happen**

> **firmly maintain a personal choice**

> **firmly assert that something is true**

All share the underlying idea of:

> **not easily changing your position despite resistance or doubt**

but the learner needs to distinguish the **action-demand** and **truth-claim** patterns clearly.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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insist on doing	即使別人有不同建議或勸阻，仍堅定地決定 / 要求自己要做某事
insist on + noun	強烈而堅定地要求某件事 / 結果必須提供或發生
insist that + statement	即使別人懷疑或不同意，仍堅定地聲稱某事為真
insist that someone do	強烈要求某人採取指定行動
insist on someone doing	堅持要求某人進行某項行動
insist upon	insist on 的較正式形式；堅持要求
insist — maintain position	面對反對仍不願改變自己的要求、決定或立場
insistence	對某項要求、立場、標準或做法所表現出的強烈堅持
at someone's insistence	因某人強烈要求，所以某件事情最終發生
insistence on	對某項做法、原則或標準一直不肯放鬆
insistent — person/request	反覆而堅定地要求某事、不容易接受拒絕的
insistent — sound/signal	持續、強烈而令人難以忽視的
insistently	以反覆、堅決而難以忽視的方式要求 / 表達

For your original passage

> “Whenever I visit, she ****insists on making tea and cutting fruit for everyone****, even when we tell her to rest.”

The exact meaning is:

****insist on doing = 堅持要做某件事，即使別人勸她不要做 / 改做其他事情****

Therefore:

> ****she insists on making tea and cutting fruit****

= ****「她總是堅持要親自為大家泡茶、切水果」****

The important contextual detail is:

> ****even when we tell her to rest****

That tells us this is stronger than:

> she likes making tea

or:

> she offers to make tea.

The family says:

> “You should rest.”

but she effectively responds:

> “No, I’ll do it.”

That is exactly the force of ****insist****.

It also reveals personality:

> care

>

> * determination

> * habit

> * unwillingness to let others serve her

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****insist on making tea****

> = 堅持要泡茶

> ****insist on a refund****

> = 堅持要求退款

> ****insist that she is fine****

> = 堅稱自己沒事

> ****insist that he leave****

> = 堅持要求他離開

> ****at her insistence****

> = 在她堅持要求下

> ****her insistence on doing everything herself****

> = 她堅持所有事情都親自做

> ****an insistent voice****

> = 堅決、不容拒絕的語氣

So ****insist**** is not simply:

> ****insist = 堅持****

The crucial learner question is:

> ****What is being insisted on?****

If it is an ****action/request****:

> ****堅持要求 / 堅持要做****

If it is a ****claim about truth****:

> ****堅稱 / 堅持說****

And in your original passage it specifically means:

****“to firmly continue wanting to make tea and cut fruit herself, despite being told to rest.”****